

Chapter 108-4

Liang Wanwan handed the article to Liang Shi to look at. "Jie, does this look like it was written by the same person?"

Liang Shi skimmed through it quickly, then passed it to Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu quickly noticed the same word usage habits and incorrect punctuation usage.

"This person... is no simple character." Xu Qingzhu said.

"They're very expensive." Liang Wanwan said. "They wrote an article about Yang Shuyan before that got over a million views. Just that one article alone earned over three hundred thousand yuan."

So the question arose—why was Liang Xinran able to hire this person?

Was she really poor?

Or had all her money gone into marketing?

Would someone who understood marketing this well act as fragile as she did at the Liang family home?

Of course not.

Even someone as slow as Liang Wanwan understood now.

"Is she faking it?" Liang Wanwan asked. "Why would she do this? What good does it do her to squeeze all of us out of the Liang family?"

"The family business." Xu Qingzhu reminded this naive little sister from the side.

Liang Wanwan paused. "Mom and Dad were already planning to draft a will early for her sake, afraid we'd swallow up her share."

So she didn't quite understand why Liang Xinran was stirring up so much trouble.

"Perhaps it's not about getting her rightful share, but about wanting to take everything for herself?" Xu Qingzhu said. "Sometimes you can't just look at the surface."

Liang Wanwan: "....."

She asked in surprise: "No way?"

Liang Shi was also more inclined toward this answer and chimed in: "Nothing's impossible."

"But she doesn't know anything about business operations. Squeezing me out doesn't matter, but if she squeezes out Da-ge and Er-ge, who's going to manage the company?" Liang Wanwan said. "Dad is already swamped as it is."

Liang Shi didn't know the answer to this question either and turned her gaze toward Xu Qingzhu, who understood these things.

Xu Qingzhu said in a deep voice: "She could hand these matters over to people who know what they're doing. But isn't she worried about being sidelined?"

Xu Qingzhu also found her a bit hard to understand.

After chatting for a while, they finally managed to pull Liang Wanwan out of her bad mood somewhat.

Then Liang Shi received a call from Liang Xinzhou, asking if she had seen Liang Wanwan. Liang Shi started a video call, and Liang Wanwan timidly greeted Liang Xinzhou.

Liang Xinzhou had originally wanted to say something, but seeing her eyes red from crying, he swallowed all his words of reproach and changed them to: "Rest well at your sister's place. Don't run around."

Liang Wanwan nodded. "Okay."

Then Liang Xinzhou turned and asked Liang Shi: "Can you look into Xu Tong's father?"

Liang Shi: "Huh? What's going on?"

Liang Xinzhou said: "His company before last was Haiwei Jewelry. He was fired on suspicion of leaking company secrets. Then he worked at another company for a month before being laid off. Have Xu Qingzhu ask Haiwei Jewelry about what exactly he leaked. I have a feeling she's connected to Liang Xinran."

Liang Shi was shocked. "That man? Doesn't his wife know?"

Liang Xinzhou said: "She probably doesn't."

Liang Shi didn't know what clues Liang Xinzhou had actually found. She glanced at Xu Qingzhu, and Xu Qingzhu nodded at her, indicating her agreement before Liang Shi accepted.

After hanging up, she discussed this matter with Xu Qingzhu. Both of them felt it was absurd.

But in the end, Xu Qingzhu summarized it with one sentence: Dogs that bite don't bark.¹

Liang Shi: "....."

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That night, Liang Wanwan slept in the guest bedroom, while Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi once again slept in the same room.

This day had been full of ups and downs. Liang Shi felt exhausted. As for sleeping in the same bed as Xu Qingzhu—the first time was unfamiliar, but the second time felt natural.

The bed sheets had just been changed at noon today. The old sheets were still in the laundry basket, unwashed. The washing machine had been occupied with their clothes, and after hanging them up it was already late. The two had rushed out, so there hadn't been time to wash the sheets.

When Liang Shi finished washing up and walked into the room, she felt as if the romantic atmosphere from that morning hadn't yet dissipated.

She got onto the bed and sat on one side. On the other side was Xu Qingzhu, who was reading a book.

Xu Qingzhu was reading a poetry collection, still entirely in English.

Liang Shi lay down, gazing at her from the side. The dim yellow light illuminated Xu Qingzhu, making her look especially radiant.

This scene was warm and cozy, perfect for a pictorial shoot. Liang Shi watched, completely mesmerized.

After a moment, Xu Qingzhu turned a page. The sound of pages rustling echoed in the room. Liang Shi's hand was pillowed under her head. Her sleeve had gotten a bit wet from washing up earlier, but it didn't matter much.

Xu Qingzhu unconsciously murmured a line in English, which could be heard fairly clearly in the quiet room.

Her English pronunciation was very pleasant to listen to, like the kind you'd often hear in foreign films.

A thought stirred in Liang Shi's heart, and she suddenly said: "Xu Qingzhu, read me a poem."

She rarely made requests of Xu Qingzhu, especially one this direct.

Because today Xu Qingzhu had told her: Liang Shi, you should be yourself.

So tonight, Liang Shi was trying to take the first step.

Xu Qingzhu's hand, which had been about to turn the page, paused. She lowered her eyes to look at Liang Shi.

Liang Shi was full of anticipation, her light brown eyes filled with warmth. Xu Qingzhu's fingertips traced along the bottom of the page.

A cool voice sounded in the room: "Teacher Liang, are you using me to complete your KPI again?"²

Liang Shi: "....."

1. "會咬人的狗不叫" (huì yǎo rén de gǒu bù jiào) is a Chinese saying meaning "dogs that bite don't bark"—implying that truly dangerous people don't show their intentions openly or make threats; they act quietly and unexpectedly. ⇐
2. KPI stands for Key Performance Indicator, a business term for measurable targets used to evaluate success. Xu Qingzhu is sarcastically suggesting that Liang Shi is only making this request to fulfill some kind of task or quota (referring to the system tasks that Liang Shi has been completing). ⇐